# ACADEMIC REGULATIONS

The following section presents the academic regulations applied to bachelor's degree programs. These regulations are meant to assist students, academic advisors, administrators, and staff in making appropriate decisions. The President, Vice Presidents, Deans, and the Registrar's Office shall be responsible for their implementation. The University Academic Board is authorized to rule on cases not covered in these regulations and mitigate problems arising from their application.

Pleading ignorance of these regulations or of related publications and announcements posted on catalog boards in various campus buildings should not exonerate students from the consequences of violating them.

Student petitions to circumvent academic rules must be verified by the academic advisor to ensure the information's authenticity before being forwarded to the responsible entity for further action.

## Duration of Study

### Minimum Period

To earn a bachelor's degree, a student must study for a minimum period while enrolled at the RHU, as indicated in the table below.

| Minimum duration to earn a bachelor's degree | | |
|---|---|---|
| College of Arts and Sciences | Bachelor of Arts<br>Bachelor of Science | Three years |
| College of Business Administration | Bachelor of Business Administration | Three years |
| College of Engineering | Bachelor of Science | Three years (equivalent to 6 regular semesters plus three summer semesters) |
| | Bachelor of Engineering | Four years (equivalent to 8 regular semesters plus three summer semesters) |

A regular semester equals a minimum of 12 earned credits for transfer purposes. To earn a bachelor's degree, a transfer student must study at least three regular semesters at RHU for a three-year program or four regular semesters for a four-year program and acquire Co-op work experience.

### Maximum Period

The maximum study period to earn a bachelor's degree, excluding semesters of approved deferment of study, is ten regular semesters for the Bachelor of Science,

Bachelor of Arts, and Bachelor of Business Administration degrees and 12 regular semesters for the Bachelor of Engineering degree.

If, for compelling reasons, a student cannot complete the bachelor's degree within the allotted period, a request for extension may be submitted through the college council for approval by the University Academic Board.

## Student Class Level

The following criteria define the student's class level:

First year: 00-29 credit hours
Second year: 30-65 credit hours
Third year: 66-99 credit hours
Fourth year: 100 or more credit hours

## Course Load

### Minimum Load

The minimum semester load is 12 credits, unless the student requires fewer credits to graduate. In exceptional cases, the College Dean may approve a reduced load of nine credits upon the recommendation of the Academic Advisor.

### Maximum Load

The maximum load in a regular semester shall be 18 credits, which may be increased to 19 upon the Dean's approval. A student may be allowed to take a maximum of 21 credit hours if s/he: (1) has a CGPA of no less than 85, (2) needs 21 credits to graduate, and has a CGPA of 73 or above.

The maximum load in a summer semester shall not exceed nine credits. A 10-credit load may be allowed if the student: (1) has a CGPA no less than 85, (2) needs ten credits to graduate and has a CGPA of 73 or above, or (3) the schedule includes a one-credit course or lab course.

The maximum load for a first-year student is 15 credits in the fall or spring semesters and nine credits in the summer semester.

### Intensive English Program (IEP) Students

In addition to the English courses, students in the IEP may take courses required by the intended program of study as listed below.

| IELP 085 | IELP 095 | IELP 100 |
|---|---|---|
| A maximum of 10 Credits | A maximum of 10 Credits | A maximum of 13 Credits |
| **College of Business Administration** | | |
| BITM 200; or MATH 189 or MATH 207; BADM 225; and ARAB 212 | BITM 200; or MATH 189 or MATH 207; BADM 225; and ARAB 212 | BITM 200; or MATH 189 or MATH 207; BADM 225; BACC 205; BADM 250; ARAB 212 |
| **College of Engineering** | | |
| MATH 190 or MATH 215; PHYS 190/ PHYS 191 or PHYS 210/ PHYS 211; and CIVE 211 or CCEE 221 | MATH 190 or MATH 215; PHYS 190/ PHYS 191 or PHYS 210/ PHYS 211; and CIVE 211 or CCEE 221 | MATH 190 or MATH 215; PHYS 190/ PHYS 191 or PHYS 210/ PHYS 211; CIVE 211 and/or CCEE 221; and CCEE 214 |
| **College of Arts and Sciences** | | |
| **COSC:** MATH 190 or MATH 210; COSC 214; and Sciences / Technology elective<br>**GRDS:** GRDS 220; FADR 220; and FADR 200<br>**ENGL:** ARAB 212 and any two college-required courses | **COSC:** MATH 190 or MATH 210; COSC 214; and Sciences / Technology elective<br>**GRDS:** GRDS 220; FADR 220; and FADR 200<br>**ENGL:** ARAB 212 and any two college-required courses | **COSC:** MATH 190 or MATH 210; COSC 214; Sciences/ Technology Elective; and BMKA 200<br>**GRDS:** GRDS 220; FADR 220; FADR 200; and FADR 215<br>**ENGL:** EDUC 222; PSYC 301; and any two college-required courses |
| **Freshman Program** | | |
| **Arts**: MATH 189; ARAB 180; or BECN 190, Natural Science Elective<br>**Science**: MATH 190, PHYS 190, ARAB 180, or Natural Science | **Arts**: MATH 189; ARAB 180; or BECN 190, Natural Science Elective<br>**Science**: MATH 190, PHYS 190, ARAB 180, or Natural Science | **Arts**: MATH 189; ARAB 180; or BECN 190, Natural Science Elective; and Social Science Elective<br>**Science**: MATH 190, PHYS 190, ARAB 180, or Natural Science; Social Science Elective |

## Schedule Modification

The student may modify the course schedule after registration by adding or dropping courses during the official drop-and-add period noted in the academic calendar. The student completes the Schedule Modifications Form, obtains approval from the academic advisor and the department chairperson, and settles any resulting financial obligations immediately after completing the transaction in RHUSIS. If the course modification results in a load of less than 12 credits or more than 18 credits, approval of the Dean is also required.

### Dropping Courses

Students who do not plan to continue in a course must drop it during the drop/add period; otherwise, they remain financially accountable for the course. A course dropped during the official drop/add period will be deleted from the student's schedule. The student will be relieved from the financial liability associated with the deleted course. If a refund is due, the provisions of the refund policy will apply.

### Adding Courses

Students may add one or more courses during the drop/add period. The student must settle the financial obligations for the course(s) by the prescribed deadlines.

### Late Registration

Students who could not register during the regular registration period may register during the drop/add period and pay a late registration fee. Due to urgent circumstances, the fee may be waived for new students or those who were unable to register earlier.

## Repeating Courses

The student must retake all failed courses when they are first offered. The student may also repeat a course in which s/he passed with a grade of “70” or lower only once to improve the CGPA. While all repeats shall remain on the student’s record, the credits of a repeated course shall count only once, and the highest grade shall be used to compute GPA. A course may not be repeated more than two times, including withdrawals.

## Substituting Courses

Upon the approval of the college Dean, a student may be allowed to take a substitute for a required major course if:

- The required course is not offered or conflicts with another required course in the semester a student is expected to graduate.
- The student failed the course three times, provided that the student is not on probation. The required and the substituted course grades shall appear on the student’s transcripts and be used to calculate the student’s CGPA.

The substitute and required courses shall meet the following criteria: the number of credits and level of the substitute course must be the same or higher; the course is in the same or a closely related field; and the course content and expected competencies are equivalent.

## Undergraduate Students Taking Graduate Courses

An undergraduate student may be allowed to register for a graduate course in substitution for a required undergraduate course not offered in the semester in which the student graduates, provided that the student's CGPA is not less than 75.

In all cases, the student must obtain the college dean's approval.

## Course Syllabus

The student is entitled to receive a detailed course syllabus at the beginning of the first class meeting. The syllabus informs students of the course's salient features and rules, helping them plan accordingly. The syllabus should include the following components: Information about the instructor – Name, contact information, office location and hours, and the manner and medium of communicating with the students; information about the course - title, brief description, prerequisites, topics covered, learning outcomes; course resources - textbook, web links, references, technology tools, and instructional materials; course activities and related deadlines - homework, quizzes, projects, research papers, presentations, group work; etc.; assessment tools and grade distribution; mapping of assessment tools with learning outcomes ensuring assessment triangulation; statement to inspire students' engagement, communication, motivation, and self-expression; and class policy on attendance, exam make-up, etc. Course instructors are expected to use Moodle resources to manage the learning process.

## Attendance

The instructor must state the attendance policy in the course syllabus. The student must attend all class meetings and course-related activities and is ultimately responsible for truancy consequences. Instructors must take attendance regularly and advise truants of the ramifications of missing classes. Suppose the number of absences reaches the 15 percent mark. In that case, the student must voluntarily withdraw from the course by following the proper withdrawal procedure and receive a W grade (see the Withdrawal section). If the student does not withdraw willingly after accruing 15% of the semester's absences, the instructor completes a ***forced withdrawal form*** and submits it to the dean for approval by the end of the tenth week of classes. The Dean's Office forwards the form to the Registrar's Office for action. Students representing the country or the University in official activities shall be allowed up to 20% absences. Suppose the absence is due to ill health or other difficult circumstances. In that case, the student must provide the course instructor with evidence and a plan to meet the course requirements by completing the ***attendance exemption form***. All absences, excused or otherwise, shall be counted, and the student will ultimately be accountable for the missed work.

If the course instructor does not require attendance at all class sessions, the applicable attendance policy for that course must be approved by the college dean and clearly stated in the course syllabus.

# Assessment and Examinations

The College Council shall establish, regularly review, and update the course evaluation and examination policies and procedures governing the college's courses. A summary of the current policies and procedures is outlined below.

## Performance Assessment

Students are allowed to assess their work and receive continuous, constructive feedback in line with university guidelines. The assessment of student performance is based on the extent to which the course outcomes stated in the syllabus are achieved. Assessment instruments may include, but are not limited to, class participation, blogs, wikis, homework, examinations, quizzes, research papers, projects, and practical work. Instructors are required to complete a midterm performance assessment and report the results before the withdrawal deadline. This process provides underperforming students with the opportunity to withdraw if necessary and enables faculty advisors to offer more effective guidance during the registration period.

## Examinations

The course syllabus must state the number and dates of exams to be given during the semester. At least one major exam should be given before the withdrawal deadline to allow the student to decide whether to continue or withdraw from the course.

The instructor is responsible for preparing written, properly weighted exam questions aligned with the course content, language of instruction, learning outcomes, and the allotted exam time stipulated in the course syllabus. An appropriate answer booklet should be given to the students with clear instructions on exam rules. The instructor shall correct the exam booklets, return them to the students within a week after the exam, and report the grades in letter and percentage form to the Department Chair a week later.

The final examinations are given during the period approved by the University and noted in the academic calendar. Instructors may need to make individual arrangements for students with more than two final examinations scheduled on the same day. A student shall not be allowed to sit in for the final examinations without settling all his/her financial obligations to the University.

## Absence from the Final Exam

If a student fails to attend a final examination without a valid excuse, the student shall receive a zero on the exam. If the student's absence from the exam is due to circumstances beyond the student’s control, the student may submit a petition to the Dean of the relevant college. If the Dean concludes that the reasons are justifiable, s/he informs the Registrar’s Office to record an incomplete “I” grade for the course. In coordination with the relevant department and course instructor, the student prepares to take a make-up exam to replace the “I” before the drop/add period of the following

semester begins. If these circumstances persist, the Dean may recommend changing the “I” grade to “WE.” For more details, refer to this catalog's ‘Incomplete Work’ section.

### Make-up Examination

The course syllabus shall state the policy on missed examinations and quizzes so that students are fully aware of it and its consequences. Usually, a student shall receive a grade of zero for the exam or quiz s/he misses. Suppose the absence is due to a legitimate excuse for which verifiable evidence is presented. In that case, the course instructor may give the student a make-up exam or shift the weight of the missed exam (except the final exam) to other course assessment items.

## Course Grades

### Course Grade Distribution

The syllabus must clearly state the course components, topics, associated assessment criteria, and grade distribution. The course grade is distributed such that appropriate weights are given to exams, quizzes, homework, projects, research papers, and student participation. In all cases, the final exam grade should not exceed 35%.

### Submission of Final Grades

The instructor shall enter the grades into RHUSIS, prepare the final course grade report in accordance with the established format, and submit the report to the Department Chair within two working days of the scheduled final exam time. Within 24 hours afterward, the department chair verifies course grade reports, secures the dean’s approval, and forwards them to the Registrar’s Office. The Registrar’s Office audits the grade reports and records them.

### Appeal of Course Grade

If a student feels that the grade s/he has attained in a course was unfair, s/he should discuss the matter with the instructor within five days of the grade being posted by the Registrar’s Office. Suppose the student and the instructor are unable to resolve the issue. In that case, the student may submit a “**Course Grade Review Petition Form**” to the Chairperson of the concerned department within two weeks after the grade is posted. If the student’s concern is legitimate, the Dean shall form a committee consisting of the department chair, the course instructor, and one other faculty member from the same department to investigate the request and adjust the grade in accordance with standard procedures.

### Incomplete Coursework

Incomplete coursework is subject to the following rules:

- A student who has completed most of the coursework satisfactorily but, for a verifiable compelling reason, is unable to complete all course requirements within the standard period may request, before the beginning of the final exam period, an extension to complete the unfinished work by submitting a "**Request for Time Extension Form**." If approved, an "I" grade will be temporarily assigned to the course. The instructor computes the course grade, with a zero assigned to the incomplete work, which shall be transferred to the course if the unfinished coursework is not completed by the deadline.
- The incomplete grade must be removed before the beginning of the drop/add period of the following semester in which the student is registered. After the unfinished work is completed and evaluated, the course instructor completes a change-of-grade form, submits it to the dean for approval, and then sends it to the Registrar's Office for final action. The final semester GPA will be calculated as soon as the final grades for the incomplete courses are submitted.
- Credit for an incomplete course will be assigned to the semester in which the course was taken.
- Graduation requirements shall be considered complete, and the student is cleared for graduation when all Incompletes are resolved.
- If the circumstances for receiving an "I" grade persist, then a grade of "WE" will be assigned to the course upon the recommendation of the Dean of the concerned College.

### Change of Grade

A course grade cannot be changed after it has been submitted. If extreme circumstances warrant a grade change, the course instructor explains the reasons on a "**Change of Grade Form**" and submits it through the department chairperson to the dean for approval, then to the Registrar's Office for final action within a maximum of two weeks of grade posting. Grades cannot be changed after the bachelor's degree is awarded.

## Grade Point Average (GPA)

### Semester GPA

The semester GPA is computed as follows:

1. Determine the course quality points by multiplying the number of course credit hours by the numeral (see the "Grading System" section below)
2. Add the total quality points and the total number of corresponding credit hours.
3. Divide the total quality points by the total credit hours.

The higher grade of a repeated course is used in the computations. A "W" grade is not included in the GPA computations.

### Cumulative GPA (CGPA)

The cumulative GPA is computed as follows: